



SAHARA STAR TOURS

PRIVATE MOROCCO EXPEDITIONS & BESPOKE TRAVEL

MARRAKECH • CASABLANCA • SAHARA DESERT • FES • TANGIER



PRIVATE MULTI-DAY ITINERARY

13-Day Morocco Grand Tour from Tangier

DURATION	DEPARTURE	FINISH	TOUR STYLE
13 Days / 12 Nights	Tangier	Tangier	100% Private Tour

ABOUT THIS JOURNEY

Private 13-day Morocco tour from Tangier (round-trip). Explore Fes, Chefchaouen. Local support and flexible planning.

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KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Merzouga Sahara and Erg Chebbi dunes
- Desert camel trekking at sunset
- UNESCO-listed Ait Ben Haddou Kasbah
- Scenic drive through the High Atlas Mountains
- Chefchaouen, Morocco's blue mountain city
- Fes medina and historic cultural sites

DETAILED PROGRAM ITINERARY

DAY 1 Arrival to Tangier – Chefchaouen

On the first day of your 13-day Absolute Morocco tour, Your driver will pick you up from your accommodation, the airport, or the port in Tangier—"the bride of the north." The city sits where the Mediterranean meets the Atlantic at Cape Spartel. You begin with a short tour of Tangier, visiting the Cave of Hercules and Cape Spartel. Enjoy free time for lunch. Afterward, you drive inland to Chefchaouen via Tetouan and the Rif Mountains, with stops for panoramic views along the way. Finally, you reach Chefchaouen. Overnight in a Riad

DAY 2 Sightseeing Chefchaouen, the Blue City

After breakfast, explore Chefchaouen with a local guide, the Blue City—also known as "Achaoun," meaning "horns" in Berber. Nestled in the Rif Mountains of northwestern Morocco, it is famous for alleys and facades painted in shades of blue and white. Stroll the charming old medina with its distinctive doors. Enjoy free time for lunch. In the afternoon, you can hike to the Spanish Mosque on the hill for a spectacular citywide view. Overnight in the same Riad.

DAY 3 Chefchaouen – Volubilis – Meknes – Fes

After breakfast, enjoy a final wander through Chefchaouen's alleys on your own, next drive to the ancient Roman ruins of Volubilis—well preserved and recognized by UNESCO as a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Admire its mosaics, columns, and archways. Continue 30 km to Meknes, the Ismaili capital, to visit Bab al-Mansour, the Sahrij Souani basin, the Royal Stables, the granary, and the Moulay Ismail Mausoleum. Proceed to Fes. Overnight in a riad.

DAY 4 Guided sightseeing in Fes

Your driver will pick you up from your Riad in Fes after breakfast to begin your immersive exploration of one of Morocco's most iconic imperial cities — Fes, the country's cultural and spiritual heart. Your journey starts with a driving tour. First, you'll stop at the magnificent Royal Palace Gate, followed by a visit to "The Mellah", the historic Jewish Quarter. Next, enjoy breathtaking views from the Borj Sud fortress, offering a stunning overlook of the ancient medina. The final stop of this portion is the Ceramic Village & School, where you'll witness traditional craftsmanship in action. Next, a walking tour, step back in time as you enter the medieval medina, a UNESCO World Heritage Site and one of the best-preserved historic towns in the Arab world. Accompanied by a knowledgeable local guide, you'll explore highlights such as the Al Attarine Madrasa, the University and Mosque of Al Quaraouiyyine — considered the oldest existing university in the world — and the colorful Chouara Tanneries, where leather is dyed using centuries-old methods. After this unforgettable journey through history, you'll be returned to your riad to Relax

DAY 5 Fes – Ifrane – Cedar Forest – Midelt – Ziz Valley – Merzouga Sahara

After breakfast, the 13-day Absolute Morocco tour heads south via Imouzzer to visit Ifrane, known for cool weather, winter snow, and alpine-style chalets—the "Switzerland of Morocco." Continue to the Cedar Forest to see Barbary macaques in their natural habitat. Enjoy free time for lunch in Midelt. Drive over the Tizi-n-Tilghmt Pass and along the Ziz Valley with scenic stops. In the afternoon, you reach Merzouga, where you switch to camels to cross the golden dunes, pausing on a high ridge for sunset. Continue to a luxury desert camp combining nomadic tradition with modern comfort. Enjoy Berber drumming around the campfire under a vast, star-filled sky.

DAY 6**Explore Merzouga – Nomads – Khamlia – Merzouga Lake – Erg Chebbi – Palm Grove**

After breakfast, dedicate the day to exploring the Merzouga region—dunes, a seasonal lake, fossil areas, small mines, and lush oases—ideal for light off-road adventures. Visit an old kohl (eyeliner) mine, next share tea with nomads in their woven tents. Continue to Khamlia village for Gnaoua music and dance; many residents trace roots to Mali, Sudan, and Niger. Enjoy free time for lunch. Stroll through a palm-tree grove and drive to the wild lake of Merzouga (often home to flamingos) before returning to Merzouga. Dinner and overnight in a hotel.

DAY 7**Merzouga – Rissani – Erfoud – Todra Gorges – Dades Valley**

Waking up early for sunrise is a must. After breakfast, leave the desert for Rissani, the former capital of Tafilalet and still a major regional market, especially lively on Tuesdays, Thursdays, and Sundays. Continue to Erfoud to visit a fossil workshop. Drive via Touroug and Tinjdad palm groves to reach the Todra Gorge, where the river has carved a dramatic canyon—an iconic site for climbers. Enjoy free time for lunch. Proceed through Boumalne Dades to the Dades Valley, stopping at the “Monkey Fingers” rock formations and a lookout over the valley. Dinner and overnight in a hotel.

DAY 8**Dades Valley – Roses Valley – Palm Groves of Skoura – Ouarzazate – Ait Ben Haddou Kasbah – High Atlas Mountains – Marrakech**

After breakfast, you continue our trip to Kalaa Magouna, to visit the Rose Valley. A Rose Festival is held annually in May. Where the locals offer their rose products, from perfumes, rose water, oil, to cosmetic products. Next, you drive through the palm groves of Skoura, before you reach Ouarzazate, where you visit the studios, in which famous movies were shot. You depart to visit the famous Kasbah of Ait Ben Haddou. A fortified village recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site by UNESCO. Furthermore, the Kasbah has appeared in many movies including: Gladiator, Alexander, The Mummy...etc. And TV series including Game Of Thrones. After that you continue to Marrakech, by driving through the Tizi n'Tichka pass, and the High Atlas Mountains. Stops will be made for lunch, and to take pictures at interesting spots. Overnight stay in a Riad in Marrakech.

DAY 9**Guided Tour sightseeing Marrakech**

After a warm breakfast, you will be exploring the Highlights of Marrakech with a local guide. As one of Morocco's historic imperial cities, Marrakech is rich in culture and architectural beauty. The tour includes a visit to the stunning 19th-century Bahia Palace, followed by the beautifully preserved Ben Youssef Madrasa, a former Islamic school showcasing traditional Moroccan design. You'll also explore the lively medina and its souks, filled with colorful stalls and skilled artisans, experience the vibrant atmosphere of Jamaa El Fna Square, and admire the Koutoubia Mosque from outside, the largest in the city. Enjoy free time for lunch. In the afternoon, meet your driver to visit the iconic Majorelle Garden (requires online pre-booking), followed by a drive through Gueliz, the modern district of Marrakech, before returning to your Riad.

DAY 10**Marrakech – Essaouira**

After breakfast, you drive west to Essaouira. On the way you will make stops to see the Argan trees plantations and cooperatives, and if you are lucky enough the goats on the trees. You reach Essaouira, formerly Mogador, one of the important coastal towns in Morocco. The city is famous for the diversity of seafood, beautiful beach and surfing sport. Enjoy free time to visit the fishing port, the ancient ramparts with cannons, and also the old medina. Finally, transfer to your hotel. Overnight stay in Essaouira.

DAY 11**Essaouira – Visit Casablanca**

Depart Essaouira and follow the highway north to Casablanca — Morocco's largest city and economic heartbeat. Your journey begins with a visit to the spectacular Hassan II Mosque, perched on a promontory overlooking the Atlantic Ocean. As the largest mosque in Morocco, its intricate architecture and seaside setting make it a must-see landmark. After some free time for lunch, you continue exploring the highlights of Casablanca. Mohammed V Square – the bustling civic center known for its colonial architecture. A photo stop at the iconic Rick's Café, inspired by the classic film Casablanca.

DAY 12**Rabat sightseeing – Assilah**

You drive along the coastline to Rabat. Rabat is one of the imperial cities in Morocco, and the current capital. You will visit the Highlights of the Moroccan capital. Including: the Hassan tower, the Mausoleum of Mohammed V and also the Kasbah of Oudaya. Enjoy free time for lunch. In the afternoon, you head north to Assilah the beautiful seaside city. Overnight stay in a Riad.

DAY 13

Assilah – Transfer to Tangier

On the last day, you depart from Assilah and head to Tangier. Drop off at your departure terminal in Casablanca airport..

INCLUSIONS & TRIP DETAILS

What's Included

- Private air-conditioned 4x4 or minivan
- Experienced local driver/guide and private transfers
- Fuel, road tolls and standard vehicle operating costs
- Accommodation in selected riads/hotels as specified in the itinerary
- Breakfasts and included dinners according to the itinerary
- Desert camel trek and access to the desert camp

Not Included

- Lunches and drinks
- Flights and airport services not explicitly listed
- Personal expenses and optional activities
- Tips and gratuities

IMPORTANT TRAVEL INFORMATION

- Transport: Private air-conditioned luxury 4x4 or Mercedes minivan with experienced licensed chauffeur.
- Accommodation: Handpicked authentic boutique riads and deluxe Sahara desert camp with private en-suite tent.
- Tailor-Made Flexibility: 100% customizable. Timing, stops, and accommodations can be modified to your exact preferences.

READY TO BOOK OR CUSTOMIZE THIS EXPEDITION?

Contact our Marrakech travel designers directly for instant assistance, route customizations, or booking inquiries:

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